

CLIENT OUTCOME STORY

Everyone was busy. Nothing was moving.

What follows is a real engagement. The client name and identifying details have been removed. The work, the scope, and the outcomes are not.

Sector: Multi-entity commercial group

Scale: 15+ legal entities across multiple jurisdictions

Engagement type: Embedded structural governance & operational architecture

Duration: Extended embedded engagement

THE SITUATION

It looked like a performance problem. It wasn't.

A fast-moving, founder-led group had grown faster than its structure. Across more than fifteen legal entities and multiple jurisdictions, the operating architecture had not kept pace. Decisions that should have taken hours were taking weeks. Approvals were disappearing into inboxes. Accountability was informal, which meant it was unreliable. The organisation was busy — genuinely, exhaustingly busy — but forward movement had stalled.

When I was brought in, the diagnosis everyone had reached was a people problem. It wasn't. It was structural.

Recurring friction is structural data. The organisation wasn't failing because of the people in it. It was failing because of the system around them.

Nobody knew who owned what. Governance existed in theory — in job titles, in org charts, in verbal agreements between leaders — but not in practice. Decisions required individuals rather than processes. When those individuals were unavailable, uncertain, or in disagreement, execution stopped.

THE DIAGNOSIS

What I found.

The engagement began with structural observation — mapping how the organisation actually behaved, not how it described itself. That distinction matters. Most organisations have documentation that says one thing and an operating rhythm that says another.



Across the group, I identified four categories of structural failure:

- Governance leakage — authority existed on paper but was routinely bypassed in practice, creating accountability gaps that compounded over time
- Decision architecture dysfunction — no clear routing for who decided what, producing approval bottlenecks and escalation dependency on senior leaders for decisions that should never have reached them
- Structural opacity — with fifteen entities across multiple jurisdictions, nobody had a clear picture of ownership, interdependency, or operating accountability across the group
- Execution dependency — operational continuity relied on specific individuals carrying institutional knowledge that was not captured, codified, or transferable

THE WORK

What I built.

The intervention covered the full operating architecture of the group. This is not a list of recommendations. These are things that were designed, built, and embedded.

Governance infrastructure

I designed a complete governance operating model — delegation of authority, decision authority matrix, approval routing framework, and escalation governance. Not as documents that would be filed and forgotten, but as operational instruments that people would actually use. Governance that lives in behaviour, not in binders.

Corporate structure visibility

The fifteen-entity ownership hierarchy was reconstructed from the ground up. Legal ownership was traced, operational interdependencies were modelled, and a corporate visibility architecture was built so that the group could see itself clearly — its structure, its exposure, and its accountability — for the first time.

Reporting and management information

Executive reporting was nonexistent in any reliable form. I designed and implemented a weekly executive reporting system, governance reporting framework, and escalation reporting structures. Leaders stopped finding out about problems when they became crises. They started finding out when they were still solvable.

Operating systems architecture

The ERP implementation — Odoo — was redesigned from a governance perspective. Most ERP implementations treat the platform as a software problem. I treated it as a governance problem: how does operational structure translate into platform logic? Workflow systems, approval design, reporting architecture, and operational visibility were all built with that framing.

SOP and governance documentation

An enterprise SOP library was designed and built, covering document governance control, escalation and exception handling, policy lifecycle governance, and meeting governance



and decision records. The organisation now has the documentation infrastructure that allows governance to be consistent, auditable, and transferable — regardless of who is in the room.

People and organisational design

Role redesign, reporting line optimisation, and accountability ownership design were all part of the structural work. This is where most engagements end — with an org chart change. This is where I begin.

THE OUTCOME

What changed.

The group now has an operating architecture that functions without individual dependency. Decisions move through structure, not through people. Governance is embedded in systems, not carried in heads. The entities are visible to each other and to the people responsible for leading them.

The work did not solve the organisation's problems by replacing its people. It solved them by redesigning the conditions in which those people operate.

Most leaders optimise within existing constraints. My work begins with redesigning the constraints themselves.

This engagement covered what would typically be distributed across a fractional COO, a governance consultant, a systems architect, and a transformation director. It was done as a single embedded engagement, working inside the organisation's operational reality — not from the outside looking in.

IF THIS IS FAMILIAR

What to do next.

If the pattern in this story is recognisable — if your organisation is busy but not moving, if decisions are slow because structure is weak, if operational continuity depends on individuals rather than systems — then the problem you have is structural.

That is solvable. But it requires working at the level of architecture, not activity.

Enquire at kaylee-jane.com

This isn't for everyone. If it's for you, you'll know.

